Figure 9.5 Pact Broker matrix showing the history of consumer and provider versions with verification status

The verification status of the contract can be in the following states:

- The contract has been successfully verified.
- The most recent verification of the contract isn't compatible.
- The contract hasn't been verified yet.
- A new version of the pact has been published since the last verification result was received.

The can-i-deploy command in the Pact Broker CLI uses the matrix to ensure that the consumer application can be deployed without risk. The query's output to the matrix determines whether the changes are backward compatible. The matrix also displays information regarding branch, tags, and environments. The Branch & Tags column and the Envs column are important for contract testing within the CI pipeline, which will be explained in more detail in chapter 10.

9.2 Pact Broker options

Before you start publishing contracts, there needs to be a solution available to receive them. As you already know from previous chapters, there needs to be an independent source of the contracts because consumers and providers code is usually kept separate. The first decision to make is whether you want to go down the open source, software as a service (SaaS), or no Pact Broker route:

- *Option 1*—Own contract storage solution, no Pact Broker (e.g., cloud storage, Amazon Simple Storage Solution [Amazon S3])
- *Option 2*—Purchase hosted Pact Broker using SmartBear's PactFlow
- *Option 3*—Self-hosted open source Pact Broker

Each solution has pros and cons, and a detailed version of the comparison table is provided in appendix A. For now, a summary of the key points is given in table 9.1.